

Untapped Potential: Why Walmart (Testing) Is Positioned to Lead on Food Waste Reduction

While specific, publicly available details on Walmart (Testing)'s food waste reduction initiatives are limited, the company's scale and existing commitment to sustainability, coupled with key personnel like Senior Sustainability Manager Jane Smith, present a significant opportunity for impactful action. ReFED believes that targeted engagement can help Walmart (Testing) unlock substantial environmental and economic benefits by addressing food waste across its operations.

The Opportunity: Leveraging Scale for Impact

Walmart (Testing)'s reach, though not detailed in the provided documents, inherently creates a large potential impact on food waste reduction. Even marginal improvements in efficiency across its supply chain and retail practices could translate into significant reductions in wasted food, associated greenhouse gas emissions, and cost savings. This scale also positions Walmart (Testing) to influence its suppliers and customers, driving systemic change across the food system.

Sustainability Leadership: Building on Existing Foundations

Jane Smith, as Senior Sustainability Manager, is a key contact for advancing food waste reduction efforts. Her role in developing and implementing sustainability initiatives across Walmart (Testing)'s operations suggests an existing framework upon which to build targeted food waste programs. Understanding the current scope of her projects and identifying opportunities to integrate food waste reduction strategies will be crucial.

Partnership Ecosystem: Strengthening Existing Ties

Walmart (Testing)'s existing partnership with Food Banks provides a foundation for expanding food donation programs. Exploring opportunities to optimize donation logistics, increase the volume of edible food rescued, and partner with additional food recovery organizations can further enhance the company's social impact. ReFED can help facilitate connections with relevant organizations and best practices in food donation.

Next Steps: A Roadmap for Collaboration

- **Initial Consultation with Jane Smith:** Schedule a meeting to understand Walmart (Testing)'s current sustainability priorities, existing food waste data collection efforts (if any), and potential barriers to implementation.
- **Data Assessment:** Work with Walmart (Testing) to identify key data points related to food waste generation across its supply chain and retail operations. This will provide a baseline for measuring progress and identifying high-impact intervention points.
- **Solutions Workshop:** Facilitate a workshop with key stakeholders from Walmart (Testing) to explore potential food waste reduction solutions tailored to the company's specific needs and context. This workshop would leverage ReFED's Insights Engine and expertise in identifying cost-effective and impactful solutions.
- **Partnership Development:** Connect Walmart (Testing) with relevant organizations and initiatives within ReFED's network to foster collaboration and accelerate the implementation of food waste

reduction strategies.

- **Impact Measurement:** Develop a framework for tracking and reporting on the environmental, economic, and social impact of Walmart (Testing)'s food waste reduction efforts. This will help demonstrate the value of these initiatives and drive continuous improvement.